



HOPE & GLORY

ESSAYS ON THE LEGACY OF THE



54TH MASSACHUSETTS REGIMENT

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GLORY

Hollywood History, Popular Culture, and the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts Regiment

AS AN ACCURATE historical portrayal of the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts Regiment, *Glory* is way off the mark. However, the filmmakers did not intend to produce a documentary of the regiment. Their aim was to provide a dramatic interpretation of the significant role African Americans played in the Civil War; they were successful in realizing that objective. *Glory* is a powerful, engaging war movie that employs the combat film framework to tell a story of courage and valor. In making the white regimental leader, Colonel Robert Gould Shaw, the focal point of the film, the filmmakers demonstrated that they are complicit with the rest of Hollywood in the way black subjects are represented in film. Ultimately, the greatest contribution of *Glory* was to stimulate tremendous interest in this important chapter in U.S. history. With broad video and forthcoming digital video disc distribution, the film continues to provoke new ways of thinking about the role of African Americans in our nation's past.

Glory, released in 1989 by Tri-Star Pictures, was produced by Freddie Fields and directed by Ed Zwick from a screenplay by Kevin Jarre. Zwick's credits include the television series *thirtysomething* and the films *About Last Night . . .*, *Courage under Fire*, and *The Siege*. Matthew Broderick portrayed Colonel Shaw, the narrator and chief protagonist of the film. An excellent group of actors portrayed a fictionalized ensemble of black soldiers of the Fifty-fourth, including Denzel Washington as the embittered ex-slave Trip; Morgan Freeman as the Southerner Rawlins, a gravedigger who eventually becomes the regiment's sergeant major; Andre Braugher as Shaw's educated Beacon Hill friend Searles; and Jihmi Kennedy as the uneducated Sharts from South Carolina. Washington's gripping portrayal earned him an Academy Award for Best Supporting Actor and turned out to be a breakthrough performance for him. He subsequently worked with Zwick in *Courage under Fire* and *The Siege*. *Glory* also received Academy Awards for Best Cinematography and Best Sound. Director of Photography Freddie Francis achieved great success in shooting the film's remarkably authentic

battle scenes. The soundtrack by James Horner featured a haunting theme and the voices of the Harlem Boys' Choir.

The opening scene of the film is at Antietam Creek, Maryland, in 1862. Wounded during the battle, Shaw hears in a field hospital that Lincoln is about to free the slaves. Later, at home in Boston at a Beacon Hill reception, Massachusetts governor John Andrew, an abolitionist and a friend of Shaw's parents, introduces Shaw to the abolitionist Frederick Douglass. Andrew asks Shaw to head a black regiment, and after a brief period of reflection he accepts. The scene then shifts to training camp in Readville, Massachusetts, where Shaw recruits a tough Irish drill sergeant, Mulcahy, to train and discipline the men. Shaw orders that Trip be publicly flogged for an unauthorized departure from camp even though he was on a search for shoes for himself. Subsequently, upon the advice of Rawlins, the colonel forces the local quartermaster to release shoes for all the men. On payday Shaw joins his men in refusing to accept any pay because the government has paid the black troops less than the white troops.

After long-awaited uniforms arrive, the regiment marches out of Boston in spring 1863 to its first assignment south in Beaufort, South Carolina. There is little action, and it becomes clear that the regiment is to be confined to service as a labor force. The regiment's first engagement is the sacking and burning of Darien, Georgia, under the command of James Montgomery. Horrified by this action, Shaw confronts his commanding officer with irregularities and succeeds in securing a transfer. At James Island, the regiment repels a Confederate force. Union commanders decide to attack Battery Wagner outside of Charleston, South Carolina. Shaw volunteers to lead the charge despite his men's exhaustion and the suicidal nature of the assault. On July 18, 1863, the Fifty-fourth manages to breach the parapets of the Confederate stronghold briefly but then is repulsed in fierce fighting with heavy casualties. The Confederates bury the fallen Shaw with his men in a mass grave. A closing graphic states: "The Massachusetts 54th lost over half of its number in the assault on Fort Wagner. The supporting white brigades also suffered heavily before withdrawing. The fort was never taken. As word of their bravery spread, Congress finally authorized the raising of black troops throughout the Union. Over 180,000 volunteered. President Lincoln credited these men of color with helping turn the tide of the war." The movie credits roll with varied still shots of the Shaw/Fifty-fourth Massachusetts Monument on the screen.

ORIGINS AND DEVELOPMENT OF THE MOVIE

How did Hollywood come to make the movie *Glory*? There are differing accounts. According to an article in *Civil War Times Illustrated*, in 1985 prolific movie producer Freddie Fields, who had previously produced *Looking for Mr. Goodbar*, *The Year of Living Dangerously*, and *American Gigolo*, and screenwriter Kevin Jarre, whose credits include *Rambo II*, were in Boston on business. As they walked through Boston Common and up the granite steps leading to Beacon Street, the article reports, their attention was caught by the breathtaking sight of the Saint-Gaudens monument. "We both felt the same thing," said Fields. "Perhaps there was a movie here. The monument was impressive." "We researched Shaw and the 54th Massachusetts and found this wonderful, unknown story of the Civil War." From that point on, Fields related, getting the movie made became a "four-year passion." He characterized the story of *Glory* as a "major moment of African-American heritage, unknown, overlooked or suppressed in history . . . a story of American heroism, of black and white men brought together in a common objective." One of the books he says the film was based on, Peter Burchard's *One Gallant Rush*, was published in 1965, so the history had hardly been suppressed. He is perhaps considering the story's absence from American popular culture to be suppression. The film credits acknowledge that the movie was based on Burchard's book, Lincoln Kirstein's volume on the monument, and the letters of Robert Gould Shaw. The movie opens with these lines: "Robert Gould Shaw, the son of wealthy Boston abolitionists, was 23 years old when he enlisted to fight in the War between the States. He wrote home regularly telling his parents of life in the gathering Army of the Potomac. These letters are collected in the Houghton Library of Harvard University." Kirstein received assistance by way of corroboration and help with a number of details from Burchard. According to Peter Burchard, after the release of *Glory* Leslie Katz, Kirstein's editor, told Burchard that Kirstein had hired Kevin Jarre to write the script in an effort to see to it that a major motion picture about Shaw would be written and produced. According to the movie's press guide, several years prior to the movie's release in 1989, Jarre met Kirstein, who inspired him to write the script. Moved by Kirstein, the founder and general director of the New York City Ballet, who had known some of Shaw's family as a youth, Jarre wrote the initial screenplay in a few weeks. In 1985 Fields acquired rights to the film and, after a few unsuccessful efforts, managed to convince Tri-Star Pictures to take on *Glory*.¹

Once the draft screenplay was in Fields's hands, *Glory* underwent an extensive development process driven by Fields and Zwick. Leslie Katz reported to Peter Burchard, who was uncertain as to the accuracy of these comments, that Kirstein was not "paid a cent for his contribution to the making of the movie" and did not like the final product. It is difficult to determine Kirstein's precise role and final assessment of the film. It is clear, however, from an examination of two draft scripts and the final film, that extensive reorganization and rewriting took place, as occurs with most Hollywood products.² It is interesting that Burchard found out about the movie only after filming was under way and made his discovery via an article in the *New York Times*. At any rate, Burchard did connect with Fields and provided extensive comments on the first script, authored solely by Jarre. His input greatly improved the final product. Burchard also composed a piece for the Tri-Star press kit. In return for his contributions, the filmmakers generously allowed the imagery of the movie to adorn the paperback reissue of Burchard's book.³

It is informative to compare the Jarre script, the later rewrite, and the final product. Early in the Jarre script there is an absurd scene with what Burchard calls "preposterous dialogue" where in Harvard Yard Shaw confronts two Southerners, fellow Harvard men, who have their black slaves in tow. It was Burchard's influence, it seems, that was responsible for the omission of this entire scene.⁴ Jarre places John Brown in a confrontation with Shaw over the depth of his abolitionist convictions at an early 1860s Beacon Hill party. The martyr Brown, of course, had been executed in December 1859. Once again, Burchard was able to sway the filmmakers, and all references to Brown were deleted. In dramatizing the creation of the unit, the movie creates a distortion that truly minimizes the magnitude of the regiment's achievement. Rather than forming in the fall and winter of 1862, as the movie portrays, it was not until February 1863 that the effort really got going, and the majority of the men did not arrive in camp until late April 1863. Since they left for South Carolina on May 28, at best the men had less than two months to train. In shorter time than any other Union regiment, the unit was created and trained to the army's highest standards. In distorting the time frame to advance the story line, the film grossly underplays what the men of the unit achieved in a remarkably brief period of time. Jarre wrote the script scorning the most elementary study of chronology, and later rewrites retained the narrative error about the period of training. Cut out of Jarre's script was a ridiculous scene of Shaw with a camp prostitute in Massachusetts and also a relationship between Shaw and the black Charlotte Forten, an actual historical fig-

ure who came from the North to teach freed slaves. (To be fair, there is some basis for speculating about a relationship between Shaw and Forten, since she was quite taken with him. However, his recent marriage and the propriety of the times in all likelihood would have precluded such a liaison.) Jarre's script included an unnecessarily heavy-handed scene of Shaw in the Union Army participating in the return of fugitive slaves. Presumably Jarre felt that this scene would provide viewers with a motive for Shaw's later commitment to the Fifty-fourth. Fortunately, this bit of inaccuracy also did not make it to the final product. Shaw's family had impeccable abolitionist credentials; his depth of commitment did not match that of his parents but was strong nonetheless. Shaw's mother, who exerted great influence on him, at first had been given a significant role in the script; rewriting led to her virtual disappearance. Whatever the significance of losing the talents of Jane Alexander, who played Sarah Shaw, the overall decision to focus the film on Shaw and the Fifty-fourth was a good one. The rewrite of the Jarre script gets to the war much more quickly and the final film even more rapidly.

Overall, the revision process made *Glory* essentially a war movie that also to a certain extent highlighted the problem of racism in nineteenth-century America. This shift accelerated the narrative pace of the movie and emphasized the elaborate battle scenes, which the *Glory* team excelled in producing. It also made *Glory* less a film about Robert Gould Shaw and more a film about all of the men of the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts.

IS GLORY GOOD HISTORY?

In many respects, the film is a poor reflection of the history of the regiment and its context. Where the filmmakers are most open to criticism is their choice to make Shaw, the white commanding officer, the hero of the film. In their depiction, Shaw takes only a few moments to decide to accept Governor Andrew's offer to command the regiment; in reality, reaching his decision was a lengthier and more complex process. It is a typical Hollywood approach to choose a white hero when making films whose ostensible subject matter is people of color. The film *Missing* was a taut, compelling drama that exposed the brutality of the Pinochet regime in Chile and the U.S. complicity with the official state violence. However, the two stars, who give outstanding performances, are both white (Jack Lemmon and Sissy Spacek). No Chilean is given a substantial part to play. A dramatic film about Steve Biko, the South African martyr, portrays white South Africans as its central protagonists. *Ghosts of Mississippi*, a film that focuses on the murdered civil rights leader

Medgar Evers, highlights the white prosecutor who eventually brought Evers's murderer to justice; James Woods's portrayal of the Klan murderer is by far the most compelling part of the film. *Mississippi Burning*, whose subject is the murder of black and white civil rights workers James Chaney, Andrew Goodman, and Michael Schwerner, stars white FBI investigators. And the litany could go on and on. What are we to make of this pattern? For one thing, the people who produce Hollywood movies are part of the entertainment industry, which wishes to create a product that sells. Films that feature stories about whites and star whites typically sell better than films such as *Malcolm X*, by Spike Lee, an exception that proves the rule. Thus, in some respects the Hollywood industry is racist, which should not seem surprising, given the pervasive racism in the overall American culture. As historian Patricia Turner declared, "It's hard to think of a single, successful commercial film in which a black hero is allowed to be the successful agent of change in any aspect of the oppression of his or her people."⁵

Closely related to the decision to make Shaw the hero and focal point of the film as narrator and central protagonist is how the filmmakers chose to represent the black enlisted men of the Fifty-fourth. Turner noted, "To use the much-quoted but very appropriate adage coined by Ralph Ellison, the real men of the 54th are *invisible* in this film." Director Zwick oddly characterized the film as faithful to the regiment's history: "So often history has to be in some ways manhandled or perverted so as to serve dramatic truths. And here was a story which unto itself, literally, with its beginning, middle and end, told a complete story and one that was utterly compelling."⁶ Ample evidence was available to the filmmakers to remain faithful to the historical record, but instead they chose to create a composite group of fictional characters. The four black soldiers featured in *Glory* experience the male bonding of training and bloody combat often played out in Hollywood war films. However, the historical truth might well have proved to be much more interesting. Frederick Douglass's two sons both served in the Union Army; Lewis Douglass, who actually served as sergeant major in the Fifty-fourth and whose letters are extant, fought in and survived the battle of Battery Wagner. William H. Carney, another member of the regiment, received the Congressional Medal of Honor, the first black to receive it, for his valor in rescuing the national flag despite the multiple wounds he sustained.

There is no question that the actors in *Glory* were sensitive to these criticisms. Denzel Washington recalled that during production, "I did express my concern to Ed [Zwick] and Freddie [Fields] that the movie not be about whites, and I think the script reflects this."⁷ Morgan Free-



Colonel Robert Gould Shaw (played by Matthew Broderick) leading the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts in the charge against Battery Wagner in *Glory*.
Courtesy Museum of Modern Art, Film Stills Archive.

man replied to critic Roger Ebert's charge that the movie focused too much on the white point of view:

I don't have a problem with that. He [screenwriter Kevin Jarre] wrote it from a place he could write a story from, the only place he could get a grip on it from. You cannot reasonably ask a white writer to do it differently. Now, if we're going to start citing some unfortunates, it might be unfortunate that a black writer didn't write it, but if a black writer had written it, there's a good chance he wouldn't have found a producer. So there you are. This is a movie that did get made, and a story that did get told, and that's what is important.⁸

Historian Barbara Fields deplored the conversion of the regiment from one consisting of free men into one of fugitive slaves. Had Lewis Douglass been included as a character, his very presence would have "blasted the fiction of the fugitive slave regiment as an illiterate, inarticulate, and politically naïve group of enlisted men." If there was one thing that the movie could not encompass, it was a substantial African American male figure, "who from the very outset could stand up and speak for himself."⁹

Asa Gordon of the Douglass Institute of Government noted: "I have attended several screenings of *Glory* in the presence of black youths and adults who clearly absorbed the film's negative messages devaluing education as a means to improve the status of African Americans in our society." He reported that he had heard some black youths use the term "snowflake," with which Trip taunted Searles, as a way to deride fellow blacks interested in intellectual pursuits.¹⁰

Glory not only ignores the actual individual enlisted men of the regiment but also creates a misleading impression of its makeup. Three of the four fictional soldiers highlighted in the film are former slaves from the South; in fact, four-fifths of the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts were Northerners who had been free throughout their lives. The film turns its back on the vitally important communities of African Americans in the nonslaveholding states. It depicts the only black Bostonian in the ensemble, Searles, as pathetically effete and incompetent.

Glory can easily mislead viewers into thinking that the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts was the first group of blacks to fight in the Union Army, when in fact that distinction belongs to two other groups, the First South Carolina Volunteers, organized in 1862 and commanded by Boston abolitionist Thomas Wentworth Higginson, and the Louisiana Native Guard. Barbara Fields asserted that one fact stands out in the history of the Civil War and is clearly demonstrated in Higginson's history of his regiment: "It was the clear-mindedness with which slaves understood the political dynamics of the war, far ahead, I may say, of Abraham Lincoln and most of the politicians."¹¹

Another deplorable aspect of the history depicted in *Glory* is the virtual absence of Frederick Douglass, the extraordinary abolitionist leader who served as a major recruiter for the regiment and whose son was an important combatant in the Fifty-fourth. In the little that we do see of Douglass, he is depicted as an older man who has virtually nothing to say. In fact, at the time that the recruitment was being organized, Douglass, a riveting orator, was a vigorous organizer in the prime of his life. For him, according to David Blight, the black soldier was "the principal symbol of an apocalyptic war, liberating warriors who alone made suffering meaningful, a physical force that gave reality to millennial hopes." Blight wondered how the makers of the film could have missed the possibilities offered by a scene of Douglass addressing black recruits. Imagine, Blight wryly commented, "the use of less apocalyptic music and more of Douglass's apocalyptic voice."¹² There was indeed a recruitment scene depicting Douglass addressing a group of young black men in Syracuse, New York, that was shot for the film but omitted in the editing process. The scene is included in the video *The True*

Story of Glory Continues, a documentary companion to *Glory* that is addressed later in the essay.

One of the most dramatic scenes in the entire film is the whipping of Trip after he has run away from camp in search of shoes. However, historian Joseph T. Glatthaar, whose overall view of *Glory* is positive, called the flogging of Trip "wholly inaccurate." It was the most disturbing scene in the movie, Glatthaar maintained. "Congress outlawed whipping [in the military] in 1861. The soldier did not desert—he was absent without leave, which was the most common offense. He would have been entitled to a hearing, and the chances are that the most punishment he would have received would have been a month without pay or confinement." Glatthaar documented several instances in other black regiments of black soldiers rebelling against mistreatment, rebellions that led to charges of mutiny and to execution. But this scene with Trip constituted a gross distortion.¹³

A glaring omission from *Glory* that serves to decontextualize the history in the film is the absence of any discussion of the draft riots in New York City, which occurred just before the attack on Battery Wagner. Shaw's mother and sisters were forced to flee their Staten Island home, and the nephew of one of the black men in the regiment was killed by rioters.¹⁴ If the filmmakers had been interested, they could have introduced this sobering historical note. The fact that the film glibly depicts white Union troops who had scuffled with the black Fifty-fourth earlier in the drama cheering them on as they march to their destiny on the beach at South Carolina only makes the problem of racism and the history of the unit more problematic.

Glory leaves the viewer with the distinct, visceral impression that the entire black regiment was wiped out at Battery Wagner. As this volume and many other studies demonstrate, that is completely inaccurate: the Fifty-fourth fought on until the end of the Civil War. Further, the movie's closing graphic misleadingly states that the fort remained in Confederate hands, whereas the Union siege eventually led to its evacuation in September 1863. Ironically, however, the evacuation of Charleston, in which "elements of the Fifty-fourth and Fifty-fifth, another black regiment, were among those who marched triumphant into the city," did not result from the fall of Wagner but rather from Sherman's triumphant march from the west.¹⁵

THE STRENGTHS OF *GLORY*

With all of its historical limitations, *Glory's* great strengths make it a significant contribution to American culture and its ongoing conver-

sation over race. *New York Times* film critic Elvis Mitchell concluded that "what we have to look at is that *Glory* started a conversation and provokes discussion, which is part of the duty of art." He characterized the film as a "good movie about a great subject," which transported and moved viewers in fundamental ways. The ensemble of black actors, Mitchell asserted, was outstanding. "I saw it with a group of kids from Los Angeles. You could feel—you could taste the excitement in the room, and that's when we have got to realize the power of movies."¹⁶

Glory is a powerful, dramatic film that makes a very important point: blacks fought in the Union Army and played a pivotal role in the central event in U.S. history. They proved their manhood and demonstrated by their willingness to fight and die with valor that they were an integral part of America. This film reveals in a manner no viewer can mistake or overlook that blacks fought for their freedom in the Civil War. African Americans did not have freedom bestowed upon them but rather won it on the battlefield and on the stage of history. *Glory* makes these basic historical insights palpable. In response to historical criticisms, producer Fields declared that the filmmakers had a challenging objective: "to make an entertaining film first. Social messages and history can be very boring, but if you put them in an entertaining film, people will learn some history and take away a message." He argued that "you can get bogged down when dealing in history. Our objective was to make a highly entertaining and exciting war movie filled with action and character."¹⁷ Judged by the criteria that Fields identifies, the film must be termed a success.

Glory makes a significant contribution to popular understanding of the African American role in the Civil War. Edward Linenthal eloquently stated this case, reprising some of Morgan Freeman's comments cited earlier.

We cannot bemoan the historical literacy of Americans and then complain too bitterly when Hollywood takes a daring step for Hollywood and produces a film that has without any question sparked in the American mind interest in this story. How many people went to *Glory* without even knowing that blacks fought for the Union in the Civil War? And even though Frederick Douglass was flattened, and even though they were not [depicted as] free people of color, this story provided a spark in the minds of young and old to make them go and read, to learn about this, to begin—and whose responsibility is it to teach them about this? It's our job as historians to deepen and add complexity to the story. This is what public history is about and it is our responsibility to do so. Hollywood has its limitations, and films, like every other kind of memorial work,

which *Glory* was, remember and forget, the same way that historians or monuments remember and forget.¹⁸

James M. McPherson asked, "Can movies teach history?" For *Glory*, he replied, the answer is yes. "Not only is it the first feature film to treat the role of black soldiers in the American Civil War, but it is also one of the most powerful and historically accurate movies ever made about that war." McPherson acknowledged that the film is not accurate in its portrayal of the history of the Fifty-fourth, but the filmmakers, he contended, chose to tell a story "not simply about the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts but about blacks in the Civil War." The movie in some ways is really not about the Fifty-fourth but rather is a metaphor for the black experience in the war. Indeed, the film quite openly and directly confronts the problem of racism in American culture by characterizing many Union Army commanders as deeply prejudiced. If the actual historical players were much more racist than the movie communicated, the fact that the topic was engaged seriously at all is worth applauding. Associate Producer Ray Herbeck asserted that the point of *Glory* was to characterize the phenomenon of the U.S. Colored Troops, a majority of whom were former slaves. From McPherson's viewpoint, with this goal as their objective, they succeeded admirably.¹⁹

Other historians have praised the film while simultaneously offering critical comments. David Blight called *Glory* a "war movie, a Civil War platoon drama that follows certain predictable formulas. But it is also a war movie that says that sometimes wars have meanings that we are obligated to discern." However haltingly or sketchily, it was at least an "initial Hollywood attempt to confront some central questions of African-American history: why did it take total war on such a scale to begin to make black people free in America? Or, why did black men in the middle of the nineteenth century have to die in battle, by the thousands, in order to be recognized as men?" If *Glory* did not do much to answer these questions, most voices in American cultural life do not even begin to discuss these difficult issues. Despite valid scholarly criticisms, wrote William S. McFeely, the film is certainly a celebration of involvement and valor and, as such, should be viewed positively.²⁰

In the closing credits of the film, the producers extend special thanks to historian Shelby Foote, who served as a consultant during production. He considered the battle details especially praiseworthy. Peter Burchard raised the interesting point that Foote may have been featured as a historical consultant in order to highlight a Southerner as the filmmakers sought support nationwide for the film—even though Foote's expertise in African American history is not distinguished.²¹

Foote's comment pinpoints a great strength of the film: the authenticity with which *Glory* depicts battle scenes, whether it is the Fifty-fourth's first baptism of fire at James Island, South Carolina, or their ill-fated assault on Battery Wagner. These battle scenes seem graphically and brutally true to life. In *Glory*, Richard Bernstein wrote in the *New York Times*, war is clearly hell. Producer Fields hired Ray Herbeck, himself a reenactor, as associate producer and historical/technical coordinator and gave him a substantial budget to ensure authenticity. Herbeck commented in the *New York Times* that this was "the first film to show the life of the common Civil War soldier—white or black—in such detail." Hollywood, he commented, does not often let "historically minded people get involved to this extent." With the help of many, Herbeck coordinated the development of a group of black Civil War reenactors who appeared in the film.²² The film credits declared: "The producers gratefully acknowledge the invaluable contribution of the thousands of living history reenactors from 20 states whose donation of time, equipment, and Civil War combat experience made this film possible."



Tumult and emotions of combat depicted in *Glory*. Courtesy Museum of Modern Art, Film Stills Archive.

THE IMPACT OF *GLORY*

According to Ray Herbeck, the film cost approximately \$20 million to produce and took in roughly \$35 million. To break even, he argued, a film has to double its budget. However, the film has proved quite successful in television broadcasts and videocassette sales and rentals since its release in 1989.²³ It seems safe to speculate that the movie was ultimately a profitable venture, although not what Hollywood would consider a blockbuster.

Based on the continuing marketability of *Glory*, Columbia Tri-Star has decided to release it in digital video disc (DVD) format. DVD has emerged as the fastest-growing format ever and is regarded as the eventual replacement for the videocassette. It should become the preeminent home viewing product because of two unique features: high-quality resolution and great capacity to store information. The major film studios are producing selected backlist titles and major new films in the DVD format. The DVD version of *Glory*, to be released sometime in 2001, will include the film itself; interviews with Ed Zwick, Morgan Freeman, and Matthew Broderick; a new documentary entitled *Voices of Glory*; and a previously produced documentary, *The True Story of Glory Continues*. *Voices of Glory*, featuring historian James Horton, focuses on the refusal of the men of the Fifty-fourth to accept wages lower than those of white soldiers and their eventual triumph on this issue.²⁴

The popular press considered the film a success. *Glory* received some negative reviews, but the positive assessments predominated. Vincent Canby in the *New York Times* called *Glory* a "beautifully acted, pageantlike" film. He made special note of the climactic battle scene: "The attack on Fort Wagner, which is the climax of the movie, comes as close to anything I've ever seen on screen to capturing the chaos and brutality that were particular to Civil War battles." *Glory*, Canby concluded, is "celebratory, but it celebrates in a manner that insists on acknowledging the sorrow. This is a good, moving, complicated film." Although disturbed by some of the film's shortcomings, David Nicholson, writing in the *Washington Post*, called *Glory* "a long overdue treatment of black participation in the Civil War," which corrects the "omission of a significant chapter in American history from popular culture." David Ansen, writing in *Newsweek*, described *Glory* as a handsome, intelligent movie that "demands attention: it opens our eyes to a war within a war most of us never knew about." Richard Schickel in *Time* was struck by the depictions of battle: "*Glory* is at its best when it shows their [referring to the men of the Fifty-fourth] proud embrace of 19th

century warfare at its most brutal. Director Edward Zwick graphically demonstrates the absurdity of lines of soldiers slowly advancing across open ground, shoulder to shoulder, in the face of withering rifle volleys and horrendous cannonade. The fact that the Fifty-fourth finally achieves respect (and opens the way for other black soldiers) only by losing half its number in a foredoomed assault on an impregnable fortress underscores this terrible irony" Stanley Kauffmann in the *New Republic* saluted *Glory* by noting that it was "not a mere exploitation of a historical circumstance with modern relevance, not a made-for-TV thesis tract" but rather an "authentic, patient, bloody, and moving work." Writing in *Commonweal*, Tom O'Brien characterized *Glory* as a "no-fuss example of how to teach inclusive history and document a minority group role in preserving America."²⁵

The film *Glory* has had a long-term, positive impact, stimulating both the visibility of and interest in the story of blacks in the Union Army. The influence has been demonstrated in a variety of areas: historical reenactment, public sculpture, genealogy, archives, books and publications, curricula, films and videos, and public programs.

Civil War historical reenactment dates back to the nineteenth century and was an almost totally white phenomenon until the making of *Glory*. William Gwaltney of the National Park Service was one of the organizers of Company B, Fifty-fourth Massachusetts Regiment, for the movie. He recalled that when "we left the film, it was not so much the movie that we were fixated on but the history. And we had great feelings of pride in having participated" in the making of *Glory* and "redoubled our efforts to tell the story." The experience of being part of the film-making, Gwaltney recounted, "gave the men of Company B and other [black reenactors], the opportunity to become involved in special events in museums, education, in parades, special programs, in various reenactments, changing the stakes in the hobby."²⁶ Though the "hobby" remains overwhelmingly white, a small but active group of black reenactors clearly bring unique commitments and a special energy to Civil War historical reenactment.

In the summer of 1998 in the Shaw neighborhood, a black community in Washington, D.C., the African-American Civil War Memorial Freedom Foundation, dedicated "Spirit of Freedom," a new monument to the blacks who fought in the Union Army. It features a "bronze statue of black soldiers in front of three low semicircular granite walls covered with stainless steel plaques listing . . . all of the black soldiers who served . . . plus the 7,000 white officers they served under." The project will eventually include a heritage center adjacent to the memorial, which is intended to complement the memorial with historical

displays and presentations. The central organizer of the project, Washington, D.C., city councillor Frank Smith Jr., developed an interest in the black soldiers who fought in the Union Army while a young civil rights worker with the Student Non-Violent Coordinating Committee in Mississippi during the 1960s. Inspired by the movie *Glory*, Smith engineered passage of a local bill calling for the memorial in 1991 and then succeeded in gaining congressional authorization for the \$2.5 million project in 1992. Clearly, the 1989 release of *Glory* proved immensely helpful in developing the necessary political momentum for these actions.²⁷

As a direct result of the activities of the African-American Civil War Memorial Freedom Foundation, Jean Douglass Greene and Jeanette Braxton Secret established the organization Descendants of African-American Union Soldiers/Sailors and Their White Officers in the Civil War, 1861-1865. Greene is the great-granddaughter of Frederick Douglass, and Secret is the great-granddaughter of Iverson Granderson, who served in the Union Navy. The purpose of the organization is to promote research and publications and to honor and commemorate African Americans who served in the Union military. Secret is the author of a guide on how to conduct such research.²⁸

In September 1997 the National Gallery of Art in Washington, D.C., placed on display in a beautifully presented exhibit the restored plaster cast of the Shaw Monument, on long-term loan from Saint-Gaudens National Historic Site in Cornish, New Hampshire. The plaster cast had remained outdoors for decades until the park decided in 1993 that they could no longer run the risk of continued exposure to the elements and the ongoing deterioration of this invaluable piece. The Saint-Gaudens Memorial Trustees, in collaboration with the National Park Service, began a fund-raising effort, which resulted in the restoration of the plaster and the casting of a bronze replica for display in Cornish. There can be little doubt that the 1989 release of *Glory* provided significant impetus to these efforts, which were primarily driven by the deterioration of the plaster and the then upcoming centennial of the monument's installation in Boston. Matthew Broderick, who portrayed Shaw in the film, was featured at the National Gallery opening.²⁹

Teachers across the country successfully utilize *Glory* in their classrooms, and the film is also a formal part of school curricula. Award-winning secondary school teacher James Percoco of Fairfax County, Virginia, shows *Glory* at the end of the Civil War unit in his U.S. history class. For him the film is a powerful depiction of a story that has long been overlooked in the classroom. Before screening the film for students, Percoco summarizes the historical inaccuracies and advises his

students "that this film is not a documentary, but rather a producer's or director's *interpretation* of the past." The film leads to "all kinds of wonderful discussions with students" concerning why the filmmakers chose to omit Lewis Douglass, why they depicted the men of the Fifty-fourth as largely former slaves, and why filmmakers created a story that leads to the false impression that Battery Wagner was the regiment's only major engagement. In short, experience has shown that *Glory* serves as an extremely effective classroom tool. It is interesting to note that Percoco utilizes the edited version created for the classroom because his "school district has a policy against showing films that are rated R."³⁰

"Utterly enveloped, inspired, and swept away" by *Glory*, businessman-educator George Gonis in 1998 produced a dress-up cap that enables young people to imagine themselves as the black and white brothers of the Fifty-fourth. His firm Round Robin, which designs toys and learning products and produces children's literature, includes the "CAPtive Readers" series, "a collection of history-inspired headwear paired with oversized, laminated bookmarks—each bookmark packed with factual information, vintage photographs, colorful graphics, and a reading list for three age groups." Gonis claims that the cap is "one of the few non-book products available for kids that addresses the evils of bigotry and the heroic struggle for abolition, civil rights, and brotherhood." Winner of a Parents' Choice award, the Fifty-fourth cap and bookmark have been extremely well received.³¹

The film also gave new life to another account of the regiment and led to a modern edition of Shaw's letters. Saint Martin's Press published Peter Burchard's excellent book *One Gallant Rush* in 1965 and over the course of a quarter-century sold between four and five thousand copies of the book. Since the book was reissued in 1989 upon the release of *Glory*, with the film depicted on the front cover, more than fifty thousand copies have been sold. This is perhaps one of the most dramatic demonstrations of how a popular film can stimulate enormous interest in a serious piece of historical work that had previously received little exposure. In the preface to his edited collection of Robert Gould Shaw's letters, Russell Duncan noted that in "the book's earliest stage—two weeks after the premiere of the movie *Glory*," the University of Georgia Press "encouraged me to move quickly on the project."³² The film also renewed interest in Luis F. Emilio's nineteenth-century history of the regiment, sparking several reprint editions.

A survey of some of the institutions holding significant archival materials relevant to Shaw and the Fifty-fourth reveals that in all cases usage of the materials skyrocketed after the release of *Glory*. In large

part because of *Glory* and, to some extent, the Ken Burns public television series *The Civil War*, there was a significant increase in the number of researchers examining materials pertaining to African American troops at the National Archives and Records Administration (NARA). Indeed, Budge Weidman, project manager of the Civil War Conservation Corps, reported that Shaw's military service record was so frequently examined as a direct result of *Glory* that it had to undergo conservation before it could be microfilmed. Weidman's corps, composed of members of the National Archives Volunteer Association, has undertaken the massive project of preparing for microfilming approximately two thousand boxes of records relating to the U.S. Colored Troops. Weidman recounted that as a result of the film she personally has fielded an increased number of calls about the men of the U.S. Colored Troops, most of them from descendants of African Americans who served in the Civil War.³³

Glory also sparked the creation of two National Park Service database projects connected with the African-American Civil War Memorial Freedom Foundation. On September 10, 1997, the Park Service announced the completion of the first phase of the "Civil War Soldiers and Sailors Names Index" project and placed more than 235,000 African American Civil War servicemen's names on its Web site. The Web site includes regimental histories of 180 African American Union regiments, with hyperlinks between soldiers' names, the regiments they served in, and the battles the regiments fought in. In addition, the National Park Service, Howard University, and the Department of the Navy have formed a partnership to compile the names of African Americans who served in the Union Navy.³⁴

Susan Halpert of Houghton Library, Harvard University, related that *Glory*, which included "strangely large credits for Houghton at the beginning of the film," had a major impact on her research facility. According to her there were a huge number of requests to examine Shaw's letters at the time of the movie's release in 1989. Another peak occurred when the movie was released on the video market. Every year since the film's release, Houghton staff have noticed a strong interest in the Shaw letters. Requests are made in person and often via phone or letter related to History Day projects. History Day is a national competition, sponsored by education groups, the National Park Service, The History Channel, and many other groups, which has stimulated the interest of young people in history. Often screenings of *Glory* in schools will trigger a burst of interest. The letters are now on microfilm, and inquirers are frequently referred to Russell Duncan's book. Donald Yacovone of the Massachusetts Historical Society reported that since 1989 the soci-

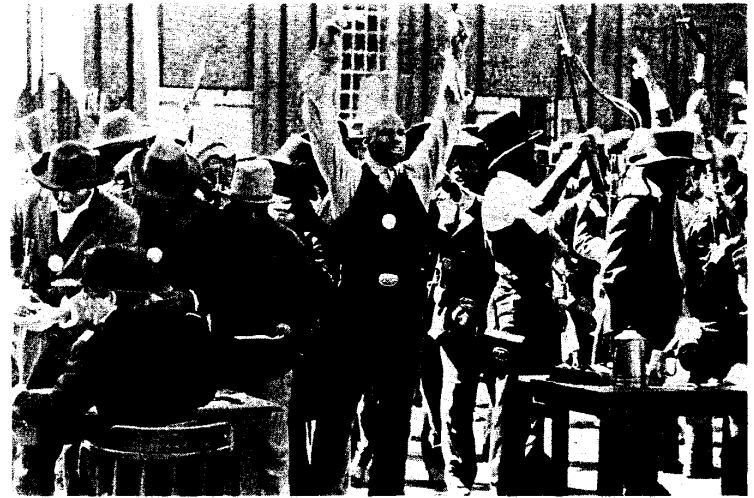
ety has witnessed a marked increase in requests to examine its collection of Shaw letters and the papers of Luis F. Emilio, whose book on the Fifty-fourth remains the fullest treatment of the regiment.³⁵

To capitalize on *Glory*'s success and, perhaps, to compensate for the film's shortcomings as history, Tri-Star Pictures issued a video, *The True Story of Glory Continues*, narrated by Morgan Freeman. Ray Herbeck, who wrote and produced the documentary, believed that it should "enhance the experience of the feature film" and noted that the two are marketed together, perhaps one of the first times a studio has employed this marketing approach. Several of Lewis Douglass's letters are quoted. The documentary treats the history of the Fifty-fourth after the assault on Battery Wagner; includes a scene dropped from *Glory* where, at a recruitment rally, Frederick Douglass exhorts young black men to enlist; and features many images and the names of several enlisted men of the regiment. The documentary addresses the financial hardships on the home front that arose because of the men's refusal to accept unequal pay. The work also focuses on the black reenactors and their efforts to educate Americans about this important chapter of American history. Overall, the documentary effectively employs illustrations, photos, and dramatic footage.³⁶

Sparked by the film *Glory*, Judy Crichton, executive producer of public television's *American Experience*, developed a documentary on the Fifty-fourth. *The Massachusetts 54th Colored Infantry*, produced by Jackie Shearer, who worked on the civil rights documentary series *Eyes on the Prize*, and Laurie Kahn-Leavitt, once again was narrated by Morgan Freeman.³⁷ This documentary, a conscious and successful attempt to correct the history that *Glory* portrayed, serves to set the regiment in its proper historical context. In his scripted introduction, series host David McCullough carefully stated:

Our film tonight deals with two large misconceptions about the Civil War. The first is that black people before the war all lived in slavery in the South, when in fact there were 500,000 free blacks about evenly divided between North and South.

The second misconception is about the term "abolitionist." Abolitionists, we learned in school, were high-minded white northerners—ministers, editors, society women, Bostonians mainly—and to be sure, a great many were. But many, too, were free northern blacks and with the onset of the war came the greatest, most influential abolitionist force by far—thousands of black men in blue uniforms, carrying Springfield rifles, volunteers, that is, soldiers of their own free will, serving in the Grand Army of the Republic. No one advocated the abolition of slavery more than they and in time, they came by the tens of thousands.



Trip (played by Denzel Washington) and fellow soldiers shred their pay vouchers rather than accept unequal pay in *Glory*. Courtesy Museum of Modern Art, Film Stills Archive.

Our film . . . is about the famous 54th Massachusetts Volunteers, the first black northern regiment to go into action. They were the men in the movie *Glory*. This is their true story, pieced together as it's never been before—from newly found photographs, old letters and diaries uncovered by producer Jacqueline Shearer and from the proud history passed down to the living descendants of the 54th.³⁸

McCullough was referencing *popular* misconceptions, assumptions among many Americans who do not read scholarly books or, possibly, any history at all. The documentary makers did not claim to have presented new historical evidence. Rather, their work frames the story of the regiment in a way that Hollywood chose not to do. The story of free blacks in the North and their centrality in the abolitionist struggle is central to an accurate historical picture of the Fifty-fourth. This is the narrative that the Shearer work provides.³⁹

The documentary effectively and movingly communicates the history of the Fifty-fourth. It outlines the rich community life of Boston's free black community on Beacon Hill, demonstrates the strength of abolitionist activity among free African Americans, portrays the recruitment efforts of free black leaders, and highlights the history of

several men of the Fifty-fourth, as well as activities of the regiment. Several descendants of men of the Fifty-fourth, including Carl Cruz, whose ancestor was William H. Carney, are prominently featured, as are such scholars as James Horton, Barbara Fields, and Massachusetts state representative Byron Rushing. Other consulting scholars included Edwin Redkey, Leon Litwack, and Sidney Kaplan.

In a moving scene of the sort missing from *Glory*, narrator Morgan Freeman relates in a voice-over that during the summer of 1865 Major Martin R. Delany, a prominent African American abolitionist who recruited for the Fifty-fourth and the army's highest-ranking African American, went to Charleston to visit his son in the Fifty-fourth. Delany addressed Port Royal ex-slaves in the church that Charlotte Forten had used as a schoolroom. Laurence Fishburne, powerfully portraying the voice of Delany, exclaims, "I want to tell you one thing. Do you know that if it was not for the black man, this war never would have been brought to a close with success to the Union and the liberty of your race if it had not been for the Negro? I want you to understand that. Do you know it? Do you know it? Do you know it?"⁴⁰

Other televised programs on the Fifty-fourth followed. The History Channel produced a 1993 documentary entitled "The 54th Massachusetts" as part of its *Civil War Journal*. Narrated by Danny Glover, this solid program also sought to fill in the history missing from *Glory*. Prominent voices in the program belong to scholar James Horton and William Gwaltney of the National Park Service, who provide excellent historical commentary. Though not overall as sophisticated as the public television program, "The 54th Massachusetts" successfully relates the basic historical context of the regiment, the composition of the men who served in the Fifty-fourth, the assault on Wagner, and the significance of the Fifty-fourth in U.S. history.

More recently, the production of *Glory* made possible the great success of Boston's 1997 centennial celebration of the Saint-Gaudens monument to Robert Gould Shaw and the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts Regiment. Certainly the film heightened interest in the monument. Appeals to major funders and supporters were made easier because all shared the experience of the film. Without this common awareness, backing for the project might have been difficult to obtain, perhaps impossible. All major aspects of the centennial program—the public ceremony featuring General Colin Powell, the largest gathering ever of black Civil War reenactors, and the public symposium—represented one of the city's most important public commemorations. To African Americans, it validated, though belatedly, the black contribution to American history. It also led to the production of two television programs focused on

the event and the meaning of the Fifty-fourth—"Return to Glory," a joint production of WCVB-TV in Boston and the Museum of Afro American History, and a documentary program produced by the black public affairs program of the local public television station, WGBH-TV. Even this volume of essays from the centennial celebration is a result of the impact of *Glory*. Interestingly, in each of the eight panels in the public symposium, which were on a wide variety of subjects, the one topic that consistently arose, often with strong feelings, was the movie *Glory*. At the final symposium session, which focused on *Glory*, William Gwaltney acknowledged that there are numerous deficiencies in the film but concluded that because of the movie, "people talk, and people are still talking, and we're talking about it again today. *Glory* means a lot of things to a lot of people."⁴¹

Gwaltney was correct in his observations. I do not think we can ask more from a Hollywood movie than what *Glory* has delivered and continues to deliver.

"For the Union Dead" in "Reading a Poem," in *Fieldwork: Sites in Literary and Cultural Studies*, ed. Marjorie Garber, Rebecca L. Walkowitz, and Paul Franklin (New York: Routledge, 1996), 129–36.

2. Steven Axelrod, "Colonel Shaw in American Poetry: 'For the Union Dead' and its Precursors," *American Quarterly* 24 (October 1972): 523–37. See 530.

3. Axelrod, "Colonel Shaw in American Poetry." Referring to and quoting from an 1897 article by William A. Coffin ("The Shaw Memorial and the Sculptor St. Gaudens," *Century Magazine*, n. s., 32 [June 1897]: 179, 181), Axelrod concludes that "the family felt that the memorial should not glorify a single man, but should rather 'typify patriotic devotion, and embody a modern spirit with heroic attributes'" (530–31).

4. Allen Tate, "Ode to the Confederate Dead," *Collected Poems: 1919–1976* (New York: Farrar, Straus, and Giroux, 1977), 20–23.

5. "Boston Common: A Meditation upon The Hero," in John Berryman, *Collected Poems, 1937–1971*, ed. and with an introduction by Charles Thornbury (New York: Farrar, Straus, and Giroux, 1989), 41. Subsequent quotations from this work, cited parenthetically in the text, also refer to this edition.

Glory: Hollywood History and Popular Culture, by Martin H. Blatt

1. C. Peter Jorgensen, "The Making of *Glory*," *Civil War Times Illustrated* 28 (November–December 1989): 53–54; Peter Burchard, *One Gallant Rush: Robert Gould Shaw and His Brave Black Regiment* (New York: Saint Martin's Press, 1965). Richard Benson and Lincoln Kirstein, *Lay This Laurel: An Album on the Saint-Gaudens Memorial on Boston Common, Honoring Black and White Men Together Who Served the Union Cause with Robert Gould Shaw and Died with Him July 18, 1863* (New York: Eakins Press, 1973). Peter Burchard to Martin Blatt, July 19, 1998. Tri-Star Pictures, *Glory* Press Guide, 1989, 16; Jim Cullen, *The Civil War in Popular Culture: A Reusable Past* (Washington, D.C.: Smithsonian Institution Press, 1995), 153; Douglas Brode, *Denzel Washington: His Films and Career* (Secaucus, N.J.: Birch Lane Press, 1997), 80–82.

2. Jorgensen, "Making of *Glory*," 54; Burchard to Blatt, July 19, 1998. I was unable to acquire a text of the final shooting script. I did obtain from a Los Angeles book dealer two scripts, *Glory* by Kevin Jarre, and *Glory* by Kevin Jarre—rewrite by Edward Zwick and Marshall Herskovitz. Warnings on both scripts indicate that no portion of the script may be quoted or published without prior written consent. So, I refrain from doing so; instead, I paraphrase or provide summaries.

3. Burchard to Blatt, July 19, 1998.

4. Burchard to Blatt, July 19, 1998.

5. See Patricia Turner, *Ceramic Uncles and Celluloid Mammies: Black Images and Their Influence on Culture* (New York: Doubleday, 1994). For her discussion of *Mississippi Burning*, see 168–71; for her discussion of *Glory*, see

172–76. Patricia Turner, panel presentation, "History on Film: *Glory* and the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts Regiment," part of public symposium, "The Monument to Robert Gould Shaw and the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts Regiment: History and Meaning," Boston (hereafter, public symposium), May 30, 1997.

6. Turner, *Ceramic Uncles and Celluloid Mammies*, 174. Although the "real men" of the Fifty-fourth such as Lewis Douglass and William H. Carney were indeed invisible in the film, the black soldiers as played by Freeman, Washington, and others came across much more vividly than the white officers. Zwick quoted in Robert Seidenberry, "Glory," *American Film* 15 (January 1990): 58.

7. Brode, *Denzel Washington*, 88.

8. "Morgan Freeman," in *The 1991 Movie Home Companion*, ed. Roger Ebert (Kansas City, Mo.: Andrews, McMeel, and Parker, 1990), 641.

9. Barbara Fields, presentation in panel, "The Impact of African-American Soldiers on the Civil War," public symposium, May 29, 1997.

10. Asa Gordon to Blatt, May 27, 1997.

11. Fields, public symposium.

12. David Blight, "The Meaning of the Fight: Frederick Douglass and the Memory of the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts," *Massachusetts Review* 36 (spring 1995): 147–48.

13. Joseph Glatthaar is the author of *Forged in Battle: The Civil War Alliance of Black Soldiers and White Officers* (New York: Free Press, 1990). He is cited in David Nicholson, "What Price *Glory*?" *Washington Post*, January 21, 1990.

14. Cullen, *Civil War in Popular Culture*, 163.

15. Burchard, *One Gallant Rush*, 150.

16. Elvis Mitchell, presentation in panel, "History on Film: *Glory* and the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts Regiment," public symposium, May 30, 1997.

17. Jorgensen, "Making of *Glory*," 59.

18. Edward Linenthal, presentation in panel, "Changing Memories of the War, 1863–1897," public symposium, May 29, 1997.

19. James McPherson, "Glory," in Mark Carnes, ed., *Past Imperfect: History according to the Movies* (New York: Henry Holt, 1995), 128, 130; Ray Herbeck, telephone interview by Blatt, June 5, 1998.

20. Blight, "Meaning of the Fight," 143. William McFeely, "In the Presence of Art," *Massachusetts Review* 36 (spring 1995): 165.

21. Richard Bernstein, "Heroes of *Glory* Fought Bigotry before All Else," *New York Times*, December 17, 1989; Peter Burchard, telephone interview by Blatt, July 3, 1998. Foote served as a principal narrator of the Ken Burns public television series *The Civil War*.

22. Bernstein, "Heroes of *Glory*," Jorgensen, "Making of *Glory*," 55; Herbeck quoted in Glenn Collins, "Glory Resurrects Its Black Heroes," *New York Times*, March 26, 1989; Herbeck, interview by Blatt, June 5, 1998.

23. Herbeck, interview by Blatt, June 5, 1998.

24. Peter Nichols, "Getting to Know the Sights and Sounds of DVD," *New*

York Times, November 21, 1999; telephone interview by Blatt with Margaret Roberts, producer, *Voices of Glory*, October 22, 1999; telephone interview by Blatt with Dan Kavanough, Mirage Productions, October 29, 1999.

25. Vincent Canby, "Black Combat Bravery in the Civil War," *New York Times*, December 14, 1989. Nicholson, "What Price *Glory*?" David Ansen, "Glory," *Newsweek*, December 18, 1989, 73. Richard Schickel, "Glory," *Time*, December 18, 1989, 91. Stanley Kauffmann, "Comrades in Arms," *New Republic*, January 8, 15, 1990; 28. Tom O'Brien, "At War with Ourselves: *Glory* & Fourth of July," *Commonweal*, February 9, 1990, 85.

26. William Gwaltney, presentation in panel, "History on Film: *Glory* and the Fifty-fourth Massachusetts Regiment," public symposium, May 30, 1997. In a bizarre twist, a Washington, D.C., paper reported in 1998 that there had been a growing number of blacks reenacting with Confederate units, in part as a response to *Glory*. The article fails to demonstrate a large groundswell, and Civil War historian James McPherson noted that black participation in the Confederate Army may have "happened on an unofficial and limited basis, but it was not a regular, sizable component of the Confederate Army." Eddie Dean, "The Black and the Gray," *Washington City Paper*, vol. 18, no. 28, July 17–23, 1998.

27. Richard Stevenson, "Civil War Regiment Receives Capital Tribute," *New York Times*, July 12, 1998; "For Black Soldiers, A Fight for Recognition," *Boston Globe*, July 12, 1998; Estella Duran, "Glory in Granite and Bronze," *Boston Globe*, July 19, 1998.

28. Jeanette Braxton Secret, *Guide to Tracing Your African American Civil War Ancestor* (Bowie, Md.: Heritage Books, 1997).

29. *The Shaw Memorial: A Celebration of an American Masterpiece* (Ft. Washington, Pa.: Eastern National, 1997). See 37 for the condition of the plaster. For a discussion of *Glory*, see Ludwig Lauerhauss Jr., "Commemoration," in *Shaw Memorial*, 47–66, esp. 62–66.

30. *Glory* is featured in Wendy Wilson and Gerald Herman, *American History on the Screen: A Teacher's Resource Book on Film and Video* (Portland, Maine: J. Weston Walch, 1994), 21–28; James Percoco, telephone interview by Blatt, December 23, 1998; James Percoco, *A Passion for the Past: Creative Teaching of U.S. History* (Portsmouth, N.H.: Heinemann, 1998), 84.

31. George Gonis to Martin Blatt, October 1, 1999; Round Robin press release, Milwaukee, Wis., spring 1999.

32. Burchard, interview by Blatt, July 3, 1998; Burchard to Blatt, July 19, 1998. Russell Duncan, ed., *Blue-Eyed Child of Fortune: The Civil War Letters of Colonel Robert Gould Shaw* (Athens: University of Georgia Press, 1992), xvii.

33. Budge Weidman to Blatt, undated; Richard Peuser to Blatt, June 17, 1998; Susan Cooper, "Records of Civil War African American Troops Inspire Major Archival Project," *Record* 3, no. 2 (November 1996); Budge Weidman, "Preserving the Legacy of the United States Colored Troops," unpublished manuscript, n.d. See Donald Yacovone, "I Am a Soldier Now," [Civil War Con-

servation Corps], *American Legacy* 3 (fall 1997): 46–49. On Ken Burns, see Robert Brent Toplin, ed., *Ken Burns's The Civil War: Historians Respond* (New York: Oxford University Press, 1996).

34. John Peterson, "African-American History in the Civil War Soldiers and Sailors Partnership," *Cultural Resource Management* 20, no. 2 (1997); Joseph P. Reidy, "The African-American Sailors' Project: The Hidden History," *Cultural Resource Management* 20, no. 2 (1997).

35. Susan Halpert, telephone interview by Blatt, June 23, 1998; Donald Yacovone, telephone interview by Blatt, June 23, 1998.

36. Herbeck, interview by Blatt, June 5, 1998.

37. Laurie Kahn-Leavitt, telephone interview by Blatt, June 5, 1998.

38. Script, "The Massachusetts 54th Colored Infantry," *The American Experience*, show no. 403, air date October 14, 1991, 1.

39. Kahn-Leavitt, interview by Blatt, June 5, 1998.

40. Script, "Massachusetts 54th Colored Infantry," 6.

41. Gwaltney, public symposium.

Glory as a Meditation on the Saint-Gaudens Monument, by Thomas Cripps

1. See Deborah Chotner and Shelley Sturman, *Augustus Saint-Gaudens' Memorial to Robert Gould Shaw and the Massachusetts Fifty-fourth Regiment* (Washington, D.C.: National Gallery of Art, 1997), for a well-crafted provenance of a "patinated" and restored plaster version of the monument that accompanied its unveiling in September 1997 at the National Gallery in Washington.

2. A good history of the changing nature of the exhibition of movies may be found in Douglas Gomery, *Shared Pleasures: A History of Movie Presentation in the United States* (Madison: University of Wisconsin Press, 1992); see also his "Coming of Television and the 'Lost' Motion Picture Audience," *Journal of Film and Video* 38 (summer 1985): 5–11.

3. For an homage to this Confederate presence in Baltimore, see Mabel Jones Tracy, *The Monumental City's Confederate Monuments to the War between the States* (Baltimore, privately printed, 1987), particularly 3–10, 21.

4. The notion of a diminished public or civic space and its link to movies has coalesced into a generalized "reception theory" that may be found in a growing literature. See, for example, Bruce Austin, *Immediate Seating: A Look at Movie Audiences* (Belmont, Calif.: Wadsworth, 1989); and as influenced by Jürgen Habermas, Miriam Hansen, *Babel and Babylon: Spectatorship in American Silent Film* (Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard University Press, 1991); Elizabeth Cohen, "Encountering Mass Culture at the Grassroots: The Experience of Chicago Workers in the 1920s," *American Quarterly* 41 (March 1989): 6–33; and, as applied to African Americans, Dan Streible, "The Harlem Theatre: Black Film Exhibition in Austin, Texas, 1920–1973," in Manthia Diawara, ed., *Black American Cinema* (New York: Routledge, 1993), 221–37.